

Migration Guide

Moving from MkDocs/Material to DocsForge is straightforward for most sites. This guide covers what migrates easily and what requires effort.

Easy to Migrate (Zero/Low Effort)

Feature	Status	Notes
Markdown content	✓ Direct	All <code>.md</code> files work as-is
Navigation (<code>nav</code>)	✓ Direct	<code>nav:</code> section copies over directly
Theme settings	✓ Direct	Colors, fonts, logos, favicons
Extra CSS/JS	✓ Direct	<code>extra_css</code> , <code>extra_javascript</code>
Markdown extensions	✓ Direct	admonition, pymdownx, etc.
Search	✓ Direct	Built-in, no config needed
Tags	✓ Direct	<code>tags:</code> plugin built-in
Git revision info	✓ Direct	Git dates displayed automatically
PWA / Service Worker	✓ Direct	Built-in, auto-generated
Sitemap	✓ Direct	Auto-generated

Requires Some Effort

Feature	Status	Migration Path
Custom hooks	⚠ Adapt	Rewrite as DocsForge plugins or use <code>hooks:</code> if compatible

Feature	Status	Migration Path
Custom plugins	⚠️ Adapt	Check if DocsForge has equivalent; otherwise rewrite
Custom templates	⚠️ Adapt	Template paths differ; check <code>docsforge/templates/</code>
Insiders features	⚠️ Adapt	Many are included in DocsForge; check feature parity
Privacy plugin	⚠️ Built-in	DocsForge includes privacy features by default
Optimize plugin	⚠️ Built-in	Asset optimization runs automatically post-build
Tags layout	⚠️ Changed	Custom tag templates moved from <code>fragments/tags/{layout}/</code> to <code>fragments/tags/{layout}-tag.html</code> and <code>fragments/tags/{layout}-listing.html</code> (flattened directory structure)

Requires Significant Effort

Feature	Status	Notes
Post-build scripts	🔧 Custom	Node.js/Python scripts that modify built HTML need porting
Deep MkDocs internals	🔧 Custom	Plugins that monkey-patch MkDocs classes
Custom extensions	🔧 Custom	Python markdown extensions with MkDocs-specific logic

MkDocs Plugin Migration Guide

MkDocs plugins are not compatible with DocsForge. Below is a mapping of common MkDocs plugins to their DocsForge equivalents or workarounds.

Built-in (Zero Effort)

These MkDocs plugins have direct built-in equivalents in DocsForge — remove from `plugins:` and they load automatically:

MkDocs Plugin	DocsForge	Notes
<code>search</code>	✓ Built-in	Lunr.js search, same behavior. Remove from config.
<code>tags</code>	✓ Built-in	Same <code>tags:</code> front matter, same tag pages. Remove from config.
<code>blog</code>	✓ Built-in	Blog with authors, categories, archives, RSS. Remove from config.
<code>minify</code>	✓ Built-in	HTML/CSS/JS minification runs automatically post-build.
<code>meta</code>	✓ Built-in	OpenGraph metadata, social previews. Included by default.
<code>privacy</code>	✓ Built-in	External asset downloading and inlining (Google Fonts, CDN resources).

Config-Compatible (Copy Plugin Config)

These MkDocs plugins are not supported, but their features can be replicated with DocsForge's built-in capabilities:

MkDocs Plugin	DocsForge Equivalent
<code>git-revision-date-localized</code>	Built-in — every page shows git revision dates automatically
<code>git-authors</code>	Built-in — author info extracted from git history
<code>macros</code>	Use Jinja2 templates or <code>extra:</code> config variables

MkDocs Plugin	DocsForge Equivalent
<code>redirects</code>	Use web server redirects (Netlify <code>_redirects</code> , nginx config, etc.)
<code>awesome-pages</code>	Use <code>nav:</code> in <code>docsforge.yml</code> — DocsForge doesn't auto-discover nav structure
<code>section-index</code>	Built-in — section index pages work automatically
<code>tooltipster-links</code>	Built-in — tooltips on reference links are included in the theme
<code>embed-external</code>	Use standard Markdown links or <code>pymdownx.snippets</code>
<code>include-markdown</code>	Built-in — <code>pymdownx.snippets</code> is enabled by default
<code>mkdocstrings</code>	Not built-in; use <code>pymdownx.snippets</code> or a custom post-build script

No Direct Equivalent (Requires Custom Work)

MkDocs Plugin	Workaround
<code>mkdocs-material/plugins/social</code>	Not built-in. Requires Pillow + CairoSVG. Install with <code>pip install docsforge[imaging]</code> and configure <code>social:</code> plugin manually.
<code>mkdocs-redirects</code>	Use server-level redirects (Cloudflare <code>_redirects</code> , nginx, etc.)
<code>mkdocs-awesome-pages</code>	Manually specify <code>nav:</code> structure
<code>mkdocs-glightbox</code>	Image lightbox not built-in. Use theme's built-in image zoom if available.
<code>mkdocs-pdf-export</code>	No built-in PDF export. Use Playwright or WeasyPrint post-build (see docsforge pdf — coming soon)
<code>mkdocs-static-i18n</code>	No built-in multi-language support. Use separate <code>docsforge.yml</code> per language or a third-party tool.

MkDocs Plugin	Workaround
<code>mkdocs-video</code>	Use standard HTML <code><video></code> tags in Markdown
<code>mkdocs-gallery</code>	Use standard Markdown image syntax
<code>mkdocs-jupyter</code>	Not supported. Export notebooks to Markdown first.
<code>mkdocs-swagger-ui-tag</code>	Not supported. Use a custom plugin or embed Swagger UI HTML directly.

Custom MkDocs Plugins

Plugins that extend MkDocs' `BasePlugin` class or hook into MkDocs events (`on_page_markdown`, `on_page_content`, etc.) need to be rewritten for DocsForge's plugin system:

1. DocsForge uses the same event names (`on_page_markdown`, `on_post_build`, etc.) — many MkDocs plugins can be adapted by changing the import from `mkdocs.plugins` to `docsforge.core.plugin_base`.
2. The config schema uses DocsForge's `Config` class instead of MkDocs' `BaseConfig`.
3. See the [plugin development guide](#) for details.

Markdown Extensions

All MkDocs-compatible Markdown extensions work directly. DocsForge uses the same `python-markdown` package with `pymdown-extensions`. Copy your `markdown_extensions:` block as-is:

```
markdown_extensions:
  - admonition
  - pymdownx.superfences
  - pymdownx.tabbed:
      alternate_style: true
  - pymdownx.tasklist:
      custom_checkbox: true
  # ... all your existing extensions work unchanged
```

The 31 most common extensions are already pre-enabled — you only need to list them if you want custom configuration.

Config Key Migration

MkDocs / Material Key	DocsForge	Notes
<code>mkdocs.yml</code>	<code>docsforge.yml</code>	Rename the file
<code>theme.name:</code> <code>material</code>	<code>theme.name:</code> <code>material</code>	Same — DocsForge bundles Material
<code>theme.features</code>	<code>theme.features</code>	Same — all Material features supported
<code>theme.palette</code>	<code>theme.palette</code>	Same — color scheme configuration
<code>theme.font</code>	<code>theme.font</code>	Same — font configuration
<code>theme.favicon</code>	<code>theme.favicon</code>	Same — relative to <code>docs_dir</code>
<code>theme.logo</code>	<code>theme.logo</code>	Same — relative to <code>docs_dir</code>
<code>theme.icon.logo</code>	<code>theme.icon.logo</code>	Same — Material icon reference
<code>markdown_extensions</code>	<code>markdown_extensions</code>	Same — fully compatible
<code>plugins</code>	<code>plugins</code>	Partial — built-in plugins work; third-party need porting
<code>extra_css</code>	<code>extra_css</code>	Same
<code>extra_javascript</code>	<code>extra_javascript</code>	Same
<code>extra</code>	<code>extra</code>	Same — custom template variables
<code>site_dir</code>	<code>site_dir</code>	Same
<code>docs_dir</code>	<code>docs_dir</code>	Same
<code>hooks</code>	<code>hooks</code>	Same — but MkDocs hook format may differ
<code>INHERIT</code>	✗ Not supported	Use YAML anchors instead

MkDocs / Material Key	DocsForge	Notes
<code>validation</code>	<code>validation</code>	Same
<code>watch</code>	<code>watch</code>	Same — extra paths to watch during serve

Deprecated / Removed Keys

Key	Status	Replacement
<code>strict</code>	✓ Moved to <code>build</code> subcommand	Use <code>docsforge build --strict</code>
<code>config_file_path</code>	Internal	Not needed in user config
<code>site_description</code>	✓ Supported	Same key
<code>site_author</code>	✓ Supported	Same key
<code>copyright</code>	✓ Supported	Same key
<code>repo_url</code>	✓ Supported	Same key
<code>repo_name</code>	✓ Supported	Same key
<code>edit_uri</code>	✓ Supported	Same key
<code>remote_branch</code>	✗ Removed	Use GitHub Actions for deployment
<code>remote_name</code>	✗ Removed	Use GitHub Actions for deployment
<code>use_directory_urls</code>	✓ Supported	Same key (default: true)

Key	Status	Replacement
<code>dev_addr</code>	✔ Supported	Same key (default: <code>127.0.0.1:8000</code>)
<code>site_url</code>	✔ Required	Must be set for social cards, sitemap, RSS

OI Wiki uses several advanced features. Here's how each maps:

OI Wiki Feature	DocsForge Equivalent	Effort
<code>hooks/on_env.py</code> (nav_math filter)	Custom plugin or hook	Medium
<code>toggle-sidebar</code> plugin	Theme customization	Low
<code>document-offsets-injection</code> extension	Built-in or custom plugin	Medium
<code>extra: disqus</code>	Disqus integration (manual)	Low
<code>extra: pagetime</code>	Built-in git date display	None
<code>_static/css/extra.css</code>	<code>extra_css</code> — direct copy	None
<code>_static/js/math-csr.js</code>	<code>extra_javascript</code> — direct copy	None
MathJax external CDN	Built-in KaTeX or MathJax	Low
Post-build Node scripts	Custom build pipeline	High

Estimated Migration Effort

- **Basic content + styling:** < 1 hour
- **Custom hooks + extensions:** 2–4 hours
- **Post-build pipeline:** 4–8 hours
- **Full OI Wiki migration:** ~1–2 days for a developer familiar with both systems

Feature Parity: Material vs DocsForge

Feature	Material	DocsForge
Material theme	✓	✓ (included)
Search	✓	✓ (built-in)
Tags	✓	✓ (built-in)
Social cards	✓ (Insiders)	✗ Not built-in
Blog	✓ (Insiders)	✓ (built-in)
Privacy plugin	✓ (Insiders)	✓ (built-in)
Optimize plugin	✓ (Insiders)	✓ (auto post-build)
PWA / Offline	✓ (Insiders)	✓ (built-in)
Git revision dates	✓ (plugin)	✓ (built-in)
Minification	✓ (Insiders)	✓ (auto)
Built-in icons	✓	✓ (58MB bundled)
Instant navigation	✓	✓
Custom admonitions	✓	✓
Mermaid diagrams	✓ (plugin)	✓ (built-in)
Code annotations	✓ (Insiders)	✓ (built-in)
Content tabs	✓	✓
Data tables	✓	✓
Tooltips	✓	✓

Step-by-Step Migration

1. Backup Your Site

```
cp mkdocs.yml mkdocs.yml.bak
git add -A && git commit -m "backup before docsforge migration"
```

2. Create docsforge.yml

Copy your `mkdocs.yml` to `docsforge.yml`. Most settings work directly:

```
site_name: Your Site
site_url: https://yourdomain.com
copyright: Copyright © 2025

nav:
  - Home: index.md
  # ... copy your nav structure

# Theme settings work as-is
theme:
  name: material
  palette:
    - media: "(prefers-color-scheme: light)"
      scheme: default
      primary: indigo
      accent: indigo
      toggle:
        icon: material/brightness-7
        name: Switch to dark mode
    - media: "(prefers-color-scheme: dark)"
      scheme: slate
      primary: indigo
      accent: indigo
      toggle:
        icon: material/brightness-4
        name: Switch to light mode

# Extra CSS/JS copy directly
extra_css:
  - stylesheets/extra.css
extra_javascript:
  - javascripts/extra.js

# Markdown extensions copy directly
markdown_extensions:
  - admonition
  - pymdownx.superfences
  - pymdownx.tabbed:
      alternate_style: true
  # ... etc

plugins:
```

```
- tags
- search
# - blog      # built-in, customize only if needed
```

3. Convert Config Keys

DocsForge uses `docsforge.yml` with the same schema as `mkdocs.yml`. Replace these keys:

MkDocs	DocsForge
<code>mkdocs.yml</code>	<code>docsforge.yml</code>
<code>site_dir</code>	<code>site_dir</code> (same)
<code>docs_dir</code>	<code>docs_dir</code> (same)
<code>plugins</code>	<code>plugins</code> (same)

4. Install DocsForge

```
pip install docsforge
```

5. Build and Test

```
cd your-project
docsforge build
# Check site/ directory
docsforge serve
```

6. Deploy

DocsForge outputs static HTML to `site/` — deploy to any static host. See [Deployment Guide](#) for platform-specific instructions.

Troubleshooting

Issue	Cause	Fix
<code>plugin not found</code>	Plugin not in DocsForge	Check feature parity or install separately

Issue	Cause	Fix
theme not found	Material theme path	DocsForge bundles Material; use <code>name: material</code>
Custom hook fails	MkDocs API differences	Update hook to use DocsForge APIs
CSS/JS not loading	Path resolution	Check paths relative to <code>docs_dir</code>
Search not working	Missing index	Ensure <code>search</code> plugin is in <code>plugins:</code>

Getting Help

- GitHub Issues: github.com/QQSHI13/docsforge/issues
- Docs: qqshi13.github.io/docsforge-docs

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